The God Who Is There

Genesis 1:1 · Psalm 19 · Exodus 3 · Isaiah 6

The big idea: Before the beginning, there was God. He needs nothing, he shows himself in the sky and speaks in his word, and he is holy beyond measure. Yet he provides the cleansing sinners cannot provide for themselves.

Before you meet: Read

Exodus 3:1–15 | Psalm 19 | Isaiah 6:1–7

Open (5 minutes)

When you were a child, what picture came to mind when someone mentioned God? Where do you think that picture came from?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"He looked, and behold, the bush was burning, yet it was not _____." *(Exodus 3:2)*

"The heavens declare the _____ of God, and the sky above proclaims his _____." *(Psalm 19:1)*

"Woe is me! For I am _____ … for my eyes have seen the _____, the LORD of hosts!" *(Isaiah 6:5)*

Discuss

1. A child asks you who made God. How would you have answered before this week? How would you answer now? *Genesis 1:1; Psalm 90:2*

2. Psalm 19 shows God speaking through the sky and through his Word. What can the stars tell you about God? What can they never tell you? *Psalm 19:1–4, 7–11*

3. Isaiah saw God's holiness and cried, "Woe is me!" Why did seeing God clearly make him see himself clearly? What did God do about it? *Isaiah 6:1–7*

Memory verse

> *"The heavens declare the glory of God, and the sky above proclaims his handiwork."*
>
> **Psalm 19:1**

Pray

Praise God that he is, that he needs nothing, and that he has spoken. Confess one way you have pictured him as small. Thank him that he takes away guilt.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 3

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Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Isaiah 6:1–7 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the three fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Matthew 3:13–17 and John 1:1–18).

Main points to land

1. Nobody made God. He is eternal and needs nothing, and everything else has life from him (Psalm 90:2; Acts 17:24–25). His name, I AM, says that he simply is (Exodus 3:14).
2. God shows himself in two ways. The sky shows his power to everyone (Psalm 19:1; Romans 1:20). Only his Word tells us his name and the way of salvation (Psalm 19:7; WCF 1.1).
3. God is holy beyond measure. Seeing him undoes us, and he himself provides the atonement (Isaiah 6:5–7). His mercy and his justice meet at the cross (Exodus 34:6–7).

Answer key (Observe)

1. consumed
2. glory; handiwork
3. lost; King

Questions people will ask

Then who made God?
Nobody. Everything that has a beginning needs a cause, and God has no beginning: "from everlasting to everlasting you are God" (Psalm 90:2). The question pictures God as one more thing inside the universe. He is the one who made it.

Closing prayer

Holy, eternal God, you were before all things and you need nothing from us. Thank you that you have spoken and shown us your name. Like Isaiah, we confess that we are unclean, and we thank you for the cleansing only you can give. Amen.